neither KIIFB nor the government will fall into the debt trap at any point of time.

Q: Being a government organisation, how you ensure transparency and efficiency which is required for successful completion of projects?

The 2016 amendment Act brought in reforms to make use of all the opportunities in the modern market in accordance with the regulations of regulatory agencies such as SEBI and RBI. The presence of independent Board members within KIIFB brings valuable expertise and oversight to the organization's decision-making process. These Board members with expertise and experience at national and international levels in the areas of governance and finance play a crucial role in ensuring transparency, accountability, and good governance. There are not many examples of such a Board in which independent members and government representatives are involved in equal proportion. With the Hon'ble Chief Minister of Kerala as the Chairperson and the Finance Minister of Kerala as the Vice-Chairperson, the Board consists of the Vice-Chairman of the State Planning Board, the Chief Secretary, the Finance Secretary, and the Law Secretary. Through the amendment, provisions have also been brought in to divert the accumulated money from the government exchequer and convert it into prudent and safe deposits. Up to 50% of the Motor Vehicle Tax and petroleum cess have been sanctioned to KIIFB under the Act to ensure repayments of KIIFB and to give confidence to the investors. The Fund Trustee Advisory Commission (FTAC) serves as a vital component of KIIFB, providing oversight and guidance in the management of funds and investments. This is also stipulated in the KIIF Amendment Act. FTAC acts as a trustee of KIIFB and ensures that all investments of KIIFB are in accordance with the objectives of the KIIF Act and that the funds in the Board are not diverted and spent. Comprised of eminent professionals from various fields, the FTAC brings together expertise in finance, economics, and related disciplines. Shri. Vinod Rai, the former C&AG, is the current chairman of FTAC.

The main task of FTAC is to closely evaluate KIIFB's fundraising, and utilization activities and issue Fidelity Certificate every six months. The certificate is issued with the approval of all the members of FTAC, certifying that the utilization of the amounts and the investment of the surplus amount is carried out in accordance with the provisions of the Act and the Scheme.

The Audits at different perspective is another impressive aspect in the governance of KIIFB. The comprehensive audit under section 14 of CAG's (DPC) Act 1971 is the most important one among this. Apart from CAG audit, there are statutory audit under section 15 of KIIFB Act, Tax Audit under Income Tax Act 1961. In compliance to the covenants under ECB, KIIFB is also doing the Peer Review Audit for the conversion of ICAI AS to Ind AS and the Risk Based Internal Audit as prescribed by the Board of KIIF.

Q: What are the major achievements of KIIFB?

The State Government envisages and implements development progress and KIIFB projects are at various stages of development. In this respect, 485 projects worth Rs. 29951.39 crore belong to the Public Works Department (PWD). As many as 96 projects worth Rs. 6487.80 crore have been sanctioned under the Water Resources Department, and 73 projects worth Rs. 5712.57 crore under the Department of Health and Family Welfare have been approved. There are 18 projects worth Rs. 5,200 crores in the Power sector and 10 projects worth Rs 2239.58 crore have been sanctioned by KIIFB for the Coastal Shipping and Inland Waterways Department. There are three projects under the IT Department worth Rs. 1412.86 crore, 10 projects worth Rs. 834.86 crore under the Department of Sports and Youth Affairs, 12 projects worth Rs. 506.11 crore under the Tourism Department, 3 projects worth Rs 600.98 crore under the Transport Department, 10 projects worth Rs 182.23 crore under the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes Department, 23 projects worth Rs 658.04 crore under the Local Self Government Department, 23 projects worth Rs 658.04 crore under the Department of Local Self Government, as well as two projects worth Rs 32.62 crore under the Revenue Department. Apart from these, there are several other projects approved by KIIFB including 17 projects worth Rs 477.28 crore under the Department of Culture, one project worth Rs 21.43 crore under the Department of Agriculture, one project worth Rs 183.06 crore under the Department of Animal Husbandry, two projects worth Rs 183.06 crore under the Department of AYUSH, one project worth Rs 17.73 crore under the Backward Classes Development Department, 2 projects worth Rs 138.51 crore under the Department of Agriculture, and 2 projects worth Rs 138.51 crore under the Department of Fisheries and Ports.

KIIFB has also approved land acquisition projects worth Rs 22,877.17 crore for various projects. This includes Rs 6,769.01 crore for land acquisition for National Highway Development for PWD-NHAI and Rs 16,108.16 crore for six land acquisition projects which includes three industrial parks, land acquisition from HNL, Kochi-Bangalore Industrial Corridor, and GIFT City. Rs 60363.18 crore and 7 land acquisition projects worth Rs 20,000 crore.

Q: Does revenue mobilising of KIIFB moving with your expectations?

A total of Rs 33,174 crore has been raised by KIIFB so far. Of this, Rs 15,410 crore is the share from the state government and Rs 17,764 crore has been raised from the financial market. This is the status of funds raised by KIIFB so far. Through its transformative projects, efficient project management, and focus on quality, KIIFB demonstrates a holistic approach to development, making it an apt model for the country as it seeks to address its infrastructure needs and uplift the lives of its citizens.

Q: How KIIFB is contributing for development of Kerala as a best governed state?

After the massive infrastructure creation in the schools which transformed the Kerala's General Education arena into a world class environment, the focus is now in the Higher Education and Health sectors. In the coming years the massive investments in the Science Parks, Translational Research and hostel facilities in the Universities will give boost in the Higher Education arena and attract foreign students to Kerala. The investment of around 6000 crores in public health will also make Kerala a global hub for treatment and health. The Water Supply Schemes of more than 6000 crores have already ensured the availability drinking water to thousands of families. Likewise the sports facilities already created at different locations in the State will attract the younger generation to the sports events and also helps in maintaining their health intact. The upcoming transport sector projects like Hill Highway, Coastal Highway and West Coast Canal will make the travelling more comfortable and avoid traffic congestions. This will also attract tourism to the State.

